WEBINAR MODULE 3

Redesigning Your Operating Model for the American System

SI-Enabled Work and Sovereign American Capability

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What You Will Leave With

- Clarity on what an operating model actually is and why it matters
- A frame for redesigning work so SI and automation elevate American roles
- Practical principles for capability-building vs. pure cost-out design
- An exercise you can apply to one major workflow this week

You will also leave with a clear split: you design the work, decisions, standards, review, and final release. SI tools extend that work. This module does not teach full bot-team management; the behavioral standard for reviewing seats lives in the Light Tetrad overlay after Module 5.

Why Operating Models Matter

An operating model defines how work is designed, how decisions are made, how performance is measured, and how improvement happens.

It is the everyday system that either builds or erodes capability.

> Most current operating models still reflect the financialization and labor-arbitrage era. Adjusting headcount or adding tools while leaving the underlying model unchanged often creates more complexity without more capability.

The Productive Pragmatism Frame

The operating model is the system that either advances or undermines these principles every day

01

Sovereign Productive Base

Build and control critical capabilities inside the United States

02

Merit & Capability

Develop real skill among American citizens with long-term stake

03

Directed Improvement

Capital and effort flow toward domestic capacity, not temporary labor extraction

04

People, Process, Place

High-capability American workers + advanced processes + domestic locations

Workforce Reality for Operating Design

Heavy reliance on temporary or short-cycle non-sovereign labor for core roles embeds fragility into the operating model itself: knowledge walks out the door, continuous improvement stalls, and innovation capacity erodes.

Diagnostic Questions

1. Which roles and workflows are truly critical to productive capacity over the next 3–5 years?
2. Does our current operating model depend on short-cycle non-sovereign labor for those workflows?
3. Are we designing work so that American talent can grow into higher-skill roles?
4. Or are we designing work that assumes continuous low-skill churn?

Location & Capability in the Operating Model

Where work sits shapes who can own it, improve it, and carry institutional knowledge forward. Offshored or temporary-heavy designs make continuous improvement harder and raise strategic risk.

Hamiltonian test: Does this location and staffing pattern strengthen domestic productive capacity and high-skill American roles — or does it lock in permanent dependence on short-cycle non-sovereign labor?

SI-Enabled Work — Elevate, Don’t Only Eliminate

An SI-native team structures roles around high-leverage human judgment, rapid iteration, and clear ownership of outcomes. Technology handles volume and repetition; people concentrate on direction, quality, integration, and improvement.

The same logic applies inside manufacturing, supply chain, and technical operations: use SI and automation to eliminate low-value work while expanding the number of high-skill American roles that design, maintain, and continuously improve the system.

How We Structure High-Leverage Work

The human sets direction, makes judgment calls, and integrates the work. Specialized agents handle depth, volume, and rapid iteration across research, drafting, and analysis — producing integrated outputs far faster than traditional methods while keeping strategic control firmly human.

> This is a practical pattern, not a product pitch: technology absorbs volume; people own direction, standards, and final release — the same split that should govern how operating models use SI on the shop floor and in the office.

When you later use bots as extensions of your work, the same split applies: you keep ownership of direction, standards, review, and final release.

Illustrative example — Weekly capacity-signal summary

Human instruction: “Read the last five days of primary filings and posts from these sources I am supplying: [list the three to five primary sources here]. Return a one-page note that names what moved, what is still open, and one decision that needs an owner. Do not recommend staffing changes.”

Bot’s bounded task: Collect and draft the one-page note from the named sources only. Stop at the draft. Do not post, do not change any file, do not invent a seat recommendation.

Review criteria: (1) Every claim has a named source. (2) Open items are listed, not solved. (3) No staffing or cost-cutting recommendations are added; relevant source facts remain accurately reported. (4) The note is one page.

Human release decision: Human reads the draft against the four criteria. If all four pass, human marks it ready for the weekly review meeting and releases it. If any fail, human returns it with the failed criterion named. The bot does not self-release.

Innovation Example

Industrial or agricultural robotics that handle repetitive physical tasks can reduce dependence on low-skill temporary labor while creating higher-skill American employment in robotics engineering, deployment, maintenance, and process optimization.

The operating model should be designed to capture that higher-skill work rather than simply bank the labor-cost reduction.

This is the difference between using technology as a headcount-reduction tool and using it as a capability-building tool.

Exercise

Identify one major workflow or function in your organization.
Sketch how the operating model around it could be redesigned so that SI and automation increase sovereign American capability instead of simply reducing headcount.

Ask: Does the redesigned work expand higher-skill American roles, or does it primarily eliminate hours?

Three Highest-Leverage Moves

1. Map one critical workflow and identify where the current operating model still depends on short-cycle non-sovereign labor or pure cost arbitrage.

2. Redefine success metrics for that workflow so they reward capability growth and domestic productive strength.

3. Align the redesigned operating model with the Business Model Canvas (Module 1) and OKR system (Module 2).

Next Steps

Canvas → OKRs → Operating Model → Value Streams → Workforce Strategy

If you would like support turning these ideas into a concrete 90-day plan or ongoing configuration and execution help, reach out directly.

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